MANATOBI / ORIGINAL PRACTICE

英検準2級プラス
リーディングトレーニング

第4回 問題冊子

リスニング・英作文を含まない部分練習 ／ 全31問

大問	問題番号	内容
1	1〜17	短文の語句空所補充
2	18〜23	長文の語句空所補充
3	24〜31	読解

使い方

・解答用紙に答えを記入してください。問題冊子には正答を載せていません。
・問題・解説はA4縦、解答用紙はA4横。白黒・片面・実際のサイズ（100%）で印刷します。
・解き終わるまでは、別冊の解答・解説を開かないでください。
・同じ問題をアプリの分野別練習でも解けます。

独自作成した英検準2級プラス形式のリーディング第4回です。リスニング・英作文・面接は含みません。公式教材ではなく、CSE・合否換算はしません。筆記全体の公式時間をリーディングだけの時間に流用しません。外部難度校正は未実施です。

氏名：＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿

1

短文の語句空所補充
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

(1) The historic canal bridge was closed for two weeks so engineers could ( ) its rusted steel beams.

1 resemble **2** reinforce **3** resign **4** relieve

(2) Because seats on the observation car are limited, passengers are advised to book well in ( ).

1 detail **2** common **3** person **4** advance

(3) Although the herbal tea tasted slightly bitter at first, it soon ( ) on me during the winter months.

1 grew **2** fell **3** came **4** kept

(4) The survey revealed a noticeable ( ) between how much sleep teenagers think they get and how much they actually sleep.

1 grip **2** gear **3** gap **4** glow

(5) Visitors to the glassblowing studio must wear protective goggles at all times without ( ).

1 expansion **2** exception **3** expression **4** expedition

1　短文の語句空所補充（続き）

(6) Many commuters were (　　) about the bus timetable revision until they saw how smoothly transfers worked.

1 fluent　**2** grateful　**3** skeptical　**4** delicate

(7) The principal promised to (　　) the shortage of bicycle racks before the new school year begins.

1 abandon　**2** admire　**3** absorb　**4** address

(8) Heavy autumn fog along the coast reduced (　　) so severely that morning ferries stayed in port.

1 visibility　**2** generosity　**3** popularity　**4** authority

(9) Installing double-paned windows cut our winter heating costs (　　) within a single season.

1 accidentally　**2** reluctantly　**3** temporarily　**4** substantially

(10) You must save your document before logging off the library computer; (　　), all unsaved changes will be erased.

1 meanwhile　**2** otherwise　**3** therefore　**4** moreover

1　短文の語句空所補充（続き）

(11) The town's ceramic bowls are prized because the local clay is remarkably (　　) to sudden changes in heat.

1 relevant　**2** reluctant　**3** resistant　**4** redundant

(12) All outdoor tennis matches were called off (　　) lightning spotted five kilometers west of the park.

1 owing to　**2** in terms of　**3** apart from　**4** prior to

(13) Before ordering three hundred uniforms, the club asked the supplier for a sample shirt to (　　) the fabric quality.

1 vanish　**2** verify　**3** violate　**4** vary

(14) Researchers caution against relying (　　) on questionnaire answers, since people often misremember daily habits.

1 solely　**2** vividly　**3** warmly　**4** swiftly

(15) Clearing fallen branches from the ramp removed an obstacle that had (　　) parents with strollers.

1 healed　**2** harvested　**3** honored　**4** hindered

1　短文の語句空所補充（続き）

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(16) The robotics club keeps spare motors on hand in the (　　) of a breakdown right before a match.

1 course　**2** aspect　**3** event　**4** behalf

(17) Far from (　　) local bookshops, the city's library reading pass actually encouraged families to buy more children's books.

1 hurt　**2** hurting　**3** hurts　**4** to hurt

2

長文の語句空所補充
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

Why Escalators Leave One Side Debate Behind

In many busy subway stations, commuters follow an unwritten rule on escalators: stand on one side and leave the other lane clear for people in a hurry. At first glance, this arrangement seems polite and efficient. In recent years, however, transit operators from Tokyo to London have begun asking riders to stand in both lanes and refrain from walking on moving steps.

Safety was the initial concern. Escalator steps are much taller than ordinary stairs, so a single misstep by someone carrying a bag can cause a chain of falls. Yet engineers studying station crowds found a second, surprising problem. When ninety percent of riders prefer to stand, reserving half the escalator for the few who walk leaves the walking lane mostly empty. (18), queues at the bottom grow longer during rush hour.

Field trials confirmed the math. Stations that guided commuters to stand two abreast moved roughly twenty-five percent more people per minute than stations using the stand-and-walk split. Standing evenly also reduced uneven mechanical wear on rollers and chains, because (19).

Changing habits formed over decades takes patience, of course. Clear floor footprints and calm voice reminders work better than scolding posters, helping riders understand that (20).

(18)

1 Until then
2 On the contrary
3 Regardless
4 As a result

(19)

1 passenger weight was balanced across both sides of the steps
2 escalators were turned off completely at noon
3 walkers carried heavier suitcases than standers
4 stations replaced metal chains with rubber bands

(20)

1 running up tall moving steps is the fastest way for everyone
2 subways should remove all escalators from deep stations
3 standing side by side gets the whole crowd upstairs faster and more safely
4 only tourists are allowed to use station elevators

Testing Acoustics with Cardboard Models

Before a city spends billions of yen building a concert hall, architects must be confident that a violin played softly on stage will sound warm and clear in the back balcony. Computer simulations have improved dramatically, yet sound waves bouncing off curved balconies, wooden slats, and hundreds of seats interact in ways that pure equations can still misjudge.

To catch acoustic flaws early, specialist teams often build scale models of a proposed hall—typically one-tenth the real size—out of varnished wood, dense cardboard, and miniature velvet chairs. Testing a one-tenth model requires a clever trick of physics. Because every wall and balcony is ten times smaller, engineers play test sounds at ten times their normal pitch so the wavelengths shrink in matching proportion. Tiny microphones placed where audience ears would be record how echoes decay. (21), designers can compare different ceiling angles in an afternoon without pouring a drop of concrete.

Even air inside the model needs adjustment. Ordinary room moisture absorbs ultra-high-frequency sound far faster than real hall air absorbs normal music. Teams therefore pump dry nitrogen into the sealed model or apply mathematical corrections so high notes do not vanish artificially fast. (22), miniature foam figures sit in the seats to imitate how clothed audiences soften reflections.

Once the real hall opens, musicians still fine-tune stage reflectors by ear. Even so, physical scale models provide (23) before construction cranes ever arrive.

(21)

1 Nevertheless
2 In this way
3 Otherwise
4 By contrast

(22)

1 Instead
2 Previously
3 Likewise
4 Otherwise

(23)

1 an excuse to skip all computer calculations
2 a reason to ban violins from concert stages
3 enough seating for two thousand real concertgoers
4 a reliable safeguard against costly acoustic surprises

3 長文の内容一致選択
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

Guidelines for the Inter-School Science Poster Exchange

From: Ms. Fujita, Science Committee Coordinator
To: Presenting Student Teams
Subject: Poster tube labels and presentation timing for Saturday

Dear student teams,
Twelve high schools will gather in our gymnasium this Saturday for the Prefectural Youth Science Poster Exchange. Please read these practical details carefully so setup goes smoothly in the morning.

Each team has been assigned a numbered display panel measuring 90 centimeters wide by 120 centimeters tall. Bring your printed A0 poster rolled inside a protective tube—do not fold it, as creases cast shadows under the gym spotlights and make small graphs hard to read. We will supply removable paper tape; thumbtacks and strong double-sided tape are prohibited because the panels are rented from the city hall.

To make sure every presenter also gets to view other schools' research, the two-hour session is split into odd-numbered and even-numbered rounds. Odd-numbered teams will stand by their panels for the first hour while even-numbered teams circulate, and then roles will reverse at 11:00 a.m. At least one member of your team must remain at your panel throughout your assigned hour.

Lunch boxes may be eaten in the second-floor cafeteria, not inside the gymnasium.

Best wishes,
R. Fujita

Guidelines for the Inter-School Science Poster Exchange — Questions

(24) Why are students instructed to roll their posters in tubes rather than fold them?

1 Creases create shadows under spotlights that make small graphs difficult to read.

2 Folded posters do not fit through the gymnasium doors.

3 The city hall charges an extra fee for folded paper.

4 Rolled posters can be hung without any tape.

(25) Why are thumbtacks and strong double-sided tape banned?

1 They interfere with wireless microphones.

2 Only odd-numbered teams know how to use them.

3 Paper posters melt when touched by metal tacks.

4 The display panels are rented from the city hall.

(26) How is the two-hour poster session organized?

1 All twelve schools present on stage one by one for ten minutes.

2 Odd- and even-numbered teams take turns presenting for an hour each so everyone can view other work.

3 Students leave their posters unattended for two hours while eating lunch.

4 Only teachers are allowed to ask questions before 11:00 a.m.

Why Botanical Illustrators Still Draw by Hand

Modern digital cameras can capture every vein on a flower petal in a fraction of a second, complete with accurate color and microscopic sharpness. Given such tools, newcomers to botanical science are often surprised to learn that major herbaria and natural history museums still commission trained artists to draw newly described plant species in pen and ink.

A photograph records a single individual plant at one exact moment—under specific lighting, with whatever insect bite, wilted leaf, or overlapping stem happens to be present that afternoon. Taxonomists naming a species, however, need an image that shows the defining traits shared across healthy specimens, free from distracting accidents. Even more importantly, a single botanical plate can combine stages of life that never appear on one plant simultaneously: spring buds, summer blossoms, autumn seed capsules, and underground root structures.

Depth of field poses another challenge under high magnification. When a camera zooms in on a tiny three-millimeter flower, the front stamens may look razor-sharp while structures two millimeters farther back blur into haze. An illustrator examining the specimen through a dissecting microscope adjusts focus continuously and draws every layer with equal clarity, using subtle line weights so viewers immediately grasp which parts sit in front.

Far from working by artistic whim, botanical illustrators collaborate closely with botanists. Before inking a final sheet, the artist prepares pencil layouts measured with calipers, and the researcher checks the angle of tiny hairs or the exact number of scales on a stem. Sometimes the act of drawing uncovers diagnostic details that the scientist had overlooked during initial notes.

Photography and illustration are therefore partners rather than rivals in plant science. Photos document habitat and living color in the field, while ink drawings distill complex three-dimensional anatomy into clear, lasting visual explanations.

Why Botanical Illustrators Still Draw by Hand — Questions

(27) What limitation of a single photograph is explained in the second paragraph?

1 Cameras cannot capture green or yellow colors outdoors.

2 Photographs fade completely within three weeks in museums.

3 It shows only one specimen at one moment and cannot combine different seasonal stages naturally.

4 Digital files cannot be sent to taxonomists in other countries.

(28) How does a botanical illustrator overcome the focus problem seen in high-magnification photography?

1 By adjusting microscope focus across layers and drawing all parts clearly with varied line weights.

2 By flattening every flower with a heavy iron before drawing.

3 By painting only plants taller than two meters.

4 By copying older photographs from nineteenth-century books.

(29) Why do botanists and illustrators work closely together during the pencil-sketch stage?

1 To choose the most expensive gold frame for an art auction.

2 To ensure measurements and tiny structural details are scientifically accurate.

3 Because botanists are not allowed to look through microscopes.

4 To invent imaginary flowers for science-fiction novels.

(30) What sometimes happens while an illustrator is carefully drawing a specimen?

1 The artist notices distinguishing features that the researcher initially missed.

2 The plant turns into a different species overnight.

3 The microscope lens melts from ink fumes.

4 All photographs of the plant are thrown away.

(31) How does the author view the relationship between photography and hand illustration in botany?

1 Hand illustration will make field cameras obsolete within five years.

2 Photography is useful only for amateurs, never for museums.

3 Both methods have been replaced by verbal descriptions alone.

4 Each method has distinct strengths that complement the other.